



OPENCLAW INSTALLATION ON HETZNER

1) STEP BY STEP (Hetzner)

1. Enter your project (example: **Default**).
2. Click **Create Server**.
3. **Location**: choose a region (Germany/Finland).
4. **Image**: Ubuntu **24.04 LTS** (recommended) or 22.04 LTS.
5. **Type**: choose your plan.
6. **SSH Keys**: do not select any (we will use password login).
7. **Firewall**: leave default (we will access via SSH port 22).
8. **Name**: example openclaw-vps
9. **Create & Buy**.

2) Get access (root password)

Hetzner sends the initial **root password by email** (to your main account email).

Then, on your Ubuntu (WSL) in Windows:

```
ssh root@YOUR_IP
```

Enter the root password.

3) Prepare Ubuntu (inside the VPS)

Once inside the server (as root), run:

```
apt update
apt install -y curl ca-certificates git nano openssl
apt upgrade -y
```

3.1 What each command does

apt update

Updates the list of available Ubuntu packages (repository catalog).
It does not install anything, only refreshes package information.

apt install -y curl ca-certificates git nano openssl

Installs basic tools:

- **curl:** download content from the internet via terminal
- **ca-certificates:** ensures HTTPS connections work properly
- **git:** clone repositories and version control
- **nano:** terminal text editor
- **openssl:** cryptography and certificate tools

-y automatically answers “yes” to confirmations.

apt upgrade -y

Upgrades installed packages to the newest versions available.
-y automatically confirms updates.

4) Create a normal user (recommended)

Still as root:

```
adduser username
usermod -aG sudo username
su - username
```

- ◆ **Note:** Replace username with any name you prefer.

In my case I used denise, but you can choose any username.

4.1 What each command does

adduser username

Creates a new user in the system.

It also:

- creates /home/username
- asks for a password
- creates the user group

usermod -aG sudo username

Grants administrator privileges via sudo.

- -G sudo = adds user to sudo group
- -a = append (keeps existing groups)

Without -a, the user could be removed from other groups.

su - username

Switches to the created user and opens a clean login session.

The - loads the full user environment (PATH, variables, etc.).

After this, commands run as that user.

When admin privileges are needed, use sudo.

OpenClaw Installation (on the VPS)

1) Install OpenClaw

As your created user:

```
curl -fsSL https://openclaw.ai/install.sh | bash
```

2) Fix “openclaw: command not found” (PATH) — if needed

If this happens, run:

```
echo 'export PATH="$HOME/.npm-global/bin:$PATH"' >>  
~/.bashrc  
source ~/.bashrc
```

Test:

```
which openclaw  
openclaw --help
```

Running `openclaw --help` lists the entire OpenClaw command interface — models, channels, gateway, plugins, security tools and diagnostics. It works as the full command reference for the tool.

3) Start the Gateway and access UI via secure tunnel

3.1 Start the gateway (on the VPS)

On the VPS (as your user), run and keep it running:

```
openclaw gateway --port 18789 --force
```

Keep this terminal open — it is the server.

3.2 Open the tunnel on your PC (Windows/WSL) — using password

On your PC, open another Ubuntu (WSL) terminal and run:

```
ssh -L 18789:127.0.0.1:18789 root@YOUR_IP
```

Enter the root password and keep this terminal open.

3.3 Open the UI in your browser

On Windows (Chrome/Edge):

```
http://127.0.0.1:18789/#token=YOUR_TOKEN
```

3.3.1 Configure Telegram (secure setup)

Fix Telegram 401 error

1. Generate a token with **@BotFather**

2. On the VPS (as your user), run:

```
openclaw config set channels.telegram.botToken  
"PASTE_YOUR_TOKEN_HERE"
```

⚠ Do not leave spaces inside the quotes.

Restart the gateway:

- In gateway terminal: Ctrl + C
- Run again:

```
openclaw gateway --port 18789 --force
```

If you get “gateway closed 1006”

Usually means:

- gateway is not running
- or you closed the gateway terminal

Check with:

openclaw health

Translated from Portuguese to English by AI.